

Introduction to Theoretical Linguistics

Phonetics, Phonology and Morphology

Assignment 8

Name _____ ID _____

Ex 1 Drawing trees

Consider the word "**reusable**". Two morphological structural analyses are proposed below:

- **Tree A:** *re- use -able*
Prefix V Suffix
V
A
- **Tree B:** *re- use -able*
Prefix V Suffix
A

Question 1

Which tree correctly represents the morphological structure of *reusable* based on standard English word-formation rules?

Question 2

Evaluate the following statements regarding the structural constraints of the prefixes and suffixes involved:

- [1] The prefix *re-* selectionally restricts its base to verbs (e.g., *rebuild*), so it must attach to the verb *use* before the adjective-forming suffix *-able* applies.

TRUE / FALSE

- [2] The suffix *-able* can only attach to complex adjectives that already contain a prefix.

TRUE / FALSE

- [3] Tree B violates the rule that suffixes must always be attached before prefixes, regardless of their part-of-speech requirements.

TRUE / FALSE

- [4] The root *use* is a noun in this context, and *re-* can only attach to nouns.

TRUE / FALSE

Ex 2 Strata

Consider the following two attempts to form a complex word using the root *friend*, the derivational suffix *-ly*, and the plural inflectional suffix *-s*:

Form A: *friend-li-ness-es* (intended meaning: “different types of being friendly.”)

Form B: *friend-s-li-ness* (intended meaning: “a state of having multiple friends.”)

Obviously, Form A is acceptable while Form B is not, despite the fact that we could imagine the intended meaning. Evaluate the following statements regarding the structural constraints of the prefixes and suffixes involved:

- [1] Inflectional affixes (like plural *-s*) always apply at the final, outermost layer of morphological derivation, meaning they cannot be trapped inside derivational affixes (like *-ness*).

TRUE / FALSE

- [2] Level 1 derivational affixes must always follow inflectional suffixes in order to allow the word’s pronunciation to stabilize.

TRUE / FALSE

- [3] The suffix *-ness* is an inflectional affix, so it must naturally precede the plural marker *-s*.

TRUE / FALSE

- [4] Derivational suffixes like *-ly* can only attach to words that have already been marked for plural number.

TRUE / FALSE

Ex 3 Morphology and phonology

Based on the following list, which affixes are considered level 1 affixes?

- | | | | |
|-----|------------------------------|---|------------------------------------|
| (1) | Base: phótograph /fóutəgræf/ | → | Derived: photográphic /fotəgræfik/ |
| (2) | Base: góvern /gávərn/ | → | Derived: góvernment /gávərnmənt/ |
| (3) | Base: órgan /ó:rgən/ | → | Derived: órganize /ó:rgənaɪz/ |
| (4) | Base: atómic /ətá:mɪk/ | → | Derived: atómicity /ætəmisəti/ |

Ex 4 Morphological trees

(i) Break down each of the following words into its component morphemes by putting slashes between them. Then, (ii) draw a tree diagram for each word to represent its morphological structure, labeling each node in the tree with its part of speech.

a . u n E u r o p e a n i z a b l e

b. irreplaceability

c. oversimplification